ZNEXORA TECH | SECURITY AWARENESS

What Happens After You Click?

One click to a full breach, minute by minute



Presented by: **ZNexora Tech** · [Presenter] · [Date]

01 · THE SETUP

Monday, 9:00 AM. An ordinary inbox.

Inbox · 47 unread

From: HR Payroll <payroll@hr-portal-update.com>

Action required: confirm your bonus details today

Hi Alex, your Q3 bonus is ready. Please review the attached summary and verify your details by 12:00 to avoid delays.

View bonus summary

Meet Alex

Works in finance. Busy Monday. Coffee in one hand, 47 emails waiting.

The email looks normal. Alex clicks.

From one click to a full breach



Minutes 0–29: **on Alex's laptop**

Day 1 onward: **across the whole company**

Illustrative scenario based on real attack patterns

The click and the trap

Verify you are human FAKE

To view your bonus summary:

1. Press Windows + R
2. Press Ctrl + V
3. Press Enter

0:00
The click
Alex opens a page that looks like a payroll portal.

0:01
The trick
A fake check asks Alex to paste and run a command.

0:01
The install
Hidden malware installs silently. Nothing looks wrong.

04 · MINUTE 2 TO 10

Silent theft, then a quiet login

0:02 · STOLEN AND SENT IN SECONDS

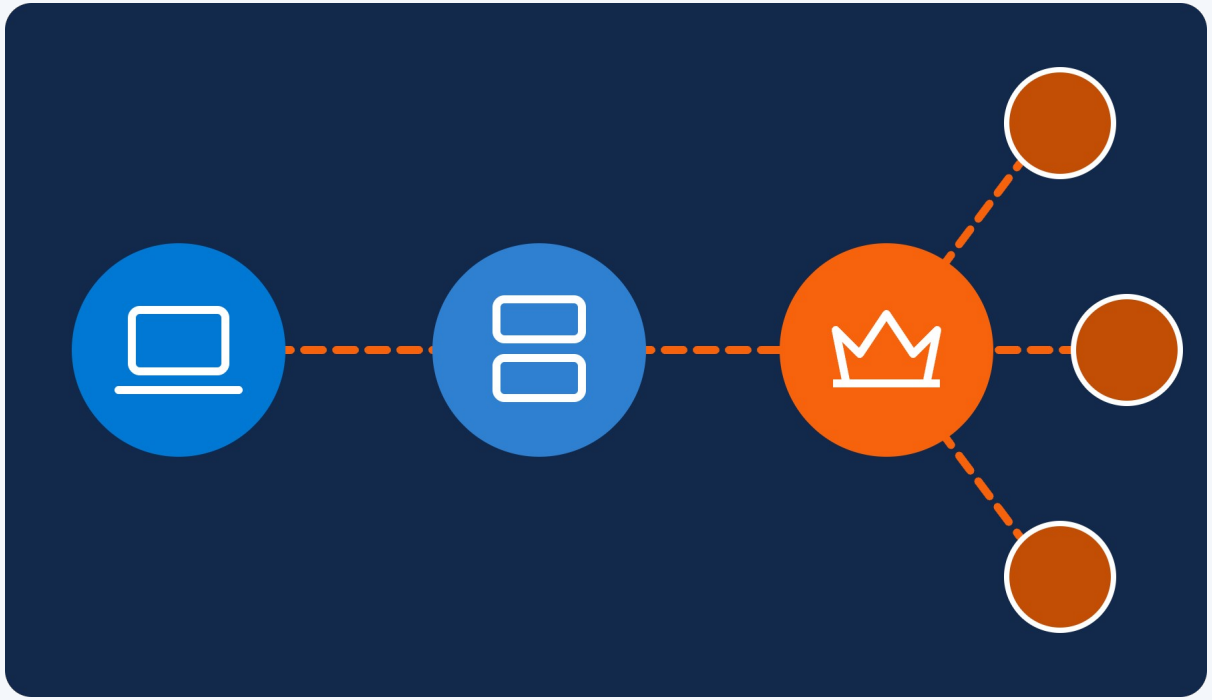
- **Saved passwords**
- **Session cookies**
- **Payment details**
- **Recent documents**

Everything is packaged and uploaded to the attacker before Alex finishes their coffee.

0:10 · THE ATTACKER BECOMES ALEX

- Logs in as Alex using the stolen session cookie: no password or MFA prompt needed
- Reads finance emails and learns who approves payments
- Creates a hidden rule forwarding invoices to the attacker

Breakout: from one laptop to the network



- Alex's laptop
- File server
- Admin account
- Every other system

29 min

average time for attackers to break out to other systems

27 sec

fastest breakout observed

Source: CrowdStrike 2026 Global Threat Report

Steal, sabotage, then encrypt

DAY 1–3

Steal the data

Customer records and financial files copied out slowly, to avoid alarms.

DAY 4

Sabotage recovery

Backups found and deleted so the company can't simply restore.

DAY 5

Encrypt everything

Ransomware runs on every system at once, often overnight or at a weekend.



What that one click can cost

$4.99M

global average cost of a breach, a record high

IBM 2026

247 days

average time to identify and contain a breach

IBM 2026

48%

of breaches now involve ransomware

Verizon DBIR 2026

Plus downtime, lost customers, legal costs and reputational damage.

Sources: IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2026 · Verizon DBIR 2026

The alternate ending

Alex stays silent

0:00	Alex clicks and runs the command
0:02	Data stolen; Alex says nothing
0:29	Attacker spreads to the network
Day 5	Ransomware; company stops

Alex reports in minute 2

0:00	Alex clicks and runs the command
0:02	Alex thinks: that was strange. Calls IT.
0:10	IT isolates the laptop, revokes sessions
0:30	Contained. One laptop rebuilt. Done.

Same click. **Thirty minutes** of cleanup instead of **months** of recovery.

09 · YOUR CHECKPOINTS

Five moments you can stop the attack

1

Before you click

Check the sender, the link and the pressure.

2

Before you run

Never paste commands a website gives you.

3

Protect your logins

MFA, a password manager, no browser-saved passwords.

4

Report in minutes

Something strange? Call IT on [contact] now.

5

Keep it updated

Updates and EDR slow attackers down.

Clicked something already? **Report it.** You will never be blamed for reporting.

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

The first minute matters most.

Pause before you click. Report the moment it feels wrong.



Thank you · Presented by ZNexora Tech